



## BEYOND THE CLASSROOM

# Discover and test-drive your passions

Project-based learning is at the core of the Maharishi School experience. Through project-based learning, students are introduced to our key principles.

## Know Yourself

Through the practice of Transcendental Meditation and a conscious curriculum, our **Know Yourself** principle

## Think Deeply

The Maharishi School's **Think Deeply** principle encourages students to approach every subject with a calm, focused mind, leading to profound

guides students to discover the quiet, confident peace within.

## Unleash Your Creativity

By first connecting to the inner self through quiet time, students at the Maharishi School learn to **Unleash Their Creativity** from a source of unlimited inspiration.

insights and creative solutions.

## Succeed

At the Maharishi School, we prepare students to **Succeed** by nurturing resilience, compassion, and self-awareness, empowering them to create a life of purpose and happiness.

# Integrating innovative and traditional educational practices is the hallmark of our successful curriculum.

Upper School students are given an hour to work on a passion project 3 days each week. They problem-solve, experiment, falter, and keep striving. Through the process, they learn real-world skills that will serve them when they are adults working on projects at their workplaces. Some of the Learning Goals for project learning are creativity, collaboration, communication, critical thinking, a growth mindset, societal impact and service, and interdisciplinary integration—all fair game for developing student portfolios.

Project period is Maharishi School's version of after-school activities or clubs, featuring award-winning teams such as robotics, rocketry, Destination Imagination, and drama, plus individual competitions such as science fair. Some projects are not competitive at all but allow students to explore creativity through studio arts, pottery, and music. Students pursue a passion for more than one quarter, especially if they are involved in interscholastic competitions, or they can enter uncharted territory by trying something on a whim. Recent offerings have included cooking, Texas Hold 'Em, film critique, script writing, and iPhone filmmaking, among others. Occasionally, students propose their own projects, working with a mentor in such areas as fitness training, classical and modern dance, or podcasting.

Almost every year, our robotics, rocketry, speech, science fair, and DI teams advance to the highest levels of competition, in which case (needless to say) the commitment requires far more than an hour three days a week. At the end of each quarter, a Showcase features performances and accomplishments, including live video coverage of everything from pottery firings to rocket launches.

## Creativity

Students achieve project outcomes in a variety of ways and are given the tools, resources, and freedom to do so. Students experiment with a variety of possible choices/solutions. Students engage in original thought based on their own understanding and experience. Students understand that foundational knowledge and basic skills allow for more nuanced creativity.

## Collaboration

Students work together to achieve project outcomes. Students apply effective strategies to get the most out of group work, in terms of conflict resolution, a division of labor, peer feedback.

## Communication

Students practice using various communication methods: reading, writing, speaking, listening, and visual expression.

## Critical Thinking

Students use goals/criteria to assess the quality of their group's ideas/outcomes. Students explore the various material and come to an informed, justified conclusion.

## Growth Mindset

Students experience that hard work and constructive critical reflection lead to improved outcomes. Students make use of opportunities to complete several drafts/prototypes for a project. Failure is delayed success.

## Societal Impact & Service

Students understand that the value of a project comes in its ability to contribute to society. Project outcomes will be considered in terms of both local and social sustainability.

## Interdisciplinary Integration

Students explore topics from a variety of perspectives and integrate skills from across disciplines to create meaningful project outcomes.

# Portfolios

Students work toward creating products that can be documented and shared.

INQUIRE TODAY!



## PROJECT THEMES

# Current & Prior Projects

|                                             |                     |
|---------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| Advanced Jazz<br>Performance and<br>History | Music Theory        |
| Advanced Rocketry<br>with Air Brake Design  | Music Competition   |
| App Prototyping                             | Myth and Watercolor |

|                                                                           |                                                      |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Aquaponics                                                                | NASA TechRise                                        |
| Architecture and Design                                                   | Novel Writing                                        |
| Art History: Creativity and Communication                                 | Painting: Acrylics and Oils                          |
| Aviation: Students can get a drone license and a student pilot's license. | Performing Arts: Iowa High School Speech Competition |
| Business Development                                                      | Performing Arts: Musical Theater                     |
| Choreography                                                              | Photography                                          |
| Claymation                                                                | Physical Fitness Coaching                            |
| Climate Change and Filmmaking                                             | Physics of Acoustic Instruments                      |
| Collaborative Creative Problem Solving                                    | Play Production                                      |
| Computer Programming                                                      | Power Poetry                                         |
| Destination Imagination                                                   | Primitive Ceramics and Raku Firing                   |
| Entrepreneurship                                                          | Product Development and Engineering                  |
| E-Sports                                                                  | Protest Songs and Acoustic Guitar Basics             |
| Experimental Music                                                        | Python and Algorithms                                |
| Fictional or Informational Video                                          | Robotics                                             |
| Film Series Production                                                    | Science Fair                                         |

|                                     |                                            |
|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| Future Business Leaders of America  | Self-Acceptance Initiative: You Are Enough |
| History of Film                     | Students for Peace                         |
| Investing                           | Sustainable Art and Fashion Design         |
| Is Peace a Myth?                    | Textile Art                                |
| Japanese Woodworking Apprenticeship | Watercolor Illustration                    |
| Movie Screenwriting                 | World Food Prize Paper                     |
| Music & Recording Arts (MICRA)      | YouTube Video Series Production            |

## Our Mission

To create an innovative Consciousness-Based educational environment where students think deeply and become creative, compassionate, contributing citizens of the world.

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